THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Source: 'The bones of the cotton weavers are bleaching the plains of India.' The speaker refers to 1

(a) a festival **(b)** collapse of the textile industry
(c) a flood **(d)** a battle

2. Planters forcing peasants to grow indigo at low rates leads to 1

(a) prosperity **(b)** wealth **(c)** debt and revolt **(d)** peace

3. If the Governor-General annexes a state by saying it is badly governed, he uses 1

(a) Subsidiary only **(b)** Lapse
(c) the charge of misrule **(d)** Cartaz

4. A ruler dies with no natural son but has adopted one. Under Lapse the British would 1

(a) leave it **(b)** annex the state
(c) give gold **(d)** recognise the heir

5. The Battle of Colachel is significant because 1

(a) it was fought in Delhi
(b) an Indian kingdom defeated a European power
(c) Europeans won
(d) British lost Bengal

6. A tax collector demands full payment despite a failed harvest. The likely result is 1

(a) surplus **(b)** peace
(c) rich farmers **(d)** debt, hunger and unrest

7. A treaty makes a ruler pay for British troops stationed in his kingdom. This is the 1

(a) Dewani **(b)** Doctrine of Lapse
(c) Cartaz **(d)** Subsidiary Alliance

8. Dupleix's use of sepoys influenced the British because 1

(a) they ignored it **(b)** they joined France
(c) they banned it **(d)** they adopted the practice

9. Why might Macaulay's policy be called unequal? 1

(a) It taught all equally
(b) It banned English
(c) It privileged English over Indian languages
(d) It supported villages

10. A foreign power sells permits for ships to sail in a sea. This is the 1

(a) iqta **(b)** mansab **(c)** hundi **(d)** cartaz system

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. 'Bones of cotton weavers' remark: what does it tell about the economy? 2

12. Why do historians check sources by European officers carefully? 2

13. Why did peasants fear indigo cultivation? 2

14. Why is the Doctrine of Lapse called unfair? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Source: 'India's share in world GDP fell from one-fourth to about 5 per cent.' Give three causes. 3

16. Compare the strategies of Dupleix and Clive. 3

17. Argue why village councils' decline hurt Indian society. 3

OR

Case: A ruler without a son adopts an heir and dies; the British annex his state. Identify the policy and an example. 3

18. Assess the importance of Colachel in global history. 3

OR

Examine how the British used religion and caste to divide Indians after 1857. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Source: 'The bones of the cotton weavers are bleaching the plains of India.' 5

(i) Who said it?
(ii) Explain the causes.
(iii) Describe the effects on weavers and towns.

OR

Examine how Indian resistance before 1857 differed from the Great Rebellion. 5

20. Evaluate the Subsidiary Alliance and the Doctrine of Lapse as tools of expansion. 5

OR

Case study: A district sees railway lines built to the port while local markets decline. Analyse the colonial economy. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks